

GROUP 22 SUMMATIVE PROJECT — HOUSESLICE MOBILE APPLICATION IN FLUTTER

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING — GROUP 22 SUMMATIVE
AFRICAN LEADERSHIP UNIVERSITY
KIGALI, RWANDA

NAME OF FACILITATOR

[INSERT FACILITATOR NAME]

July, 2026

GROUP ACTIVITIES

DEMO VIDEO LINK: [\[INSERT YOUTUBE LINK\]](#)

GITHUB LINK: <https://github.com/davidmuo/houslice>

GROUP CONTRIBUTION TRACKER: [\[INSERT SHARED TRACKER LINK\]](#)

S/N	Group Member	Role	Attendance	Commits	Contribution
1	Aime Ndayambaje	Authentication lead	19–31 July 2026	39	Built the entire authentication feature: the AppUser entity, AuthRepository contract, AuthBloc with its events and states, and the SignIn, SignUp, SignOut, GetCurrentUser and ChangePassword use cases. Implemented FirebaseAuthDataSource and MockAuthDataSource, and built the Register, Sign In, New Password and Social Buttons screens. Also established the project tooling (analysis_options.yaml, .gitignore, .metadata, pubspec.yaml) and contributed authentication test suites.
2	Isimbi Nelly	App infrastructure and testing lead	19–31 July 2026	10	Wired the application together: main.dart, app.dart, the get_it injection container and firebase_options.dart. Built the theme system and shared widget library, the router and ToggleCubit, and the error-handling core (Failure, Result, the UseCase base class, validators and formatters). Delivered the onboarding, notifications and profile features, and authored the auth, lifestyle, booking, property and shell test suites.
3	Nkuba Junior Igiraneza	Booking module lead	19–31 July 2026	10	Delivered the booking feature end to end: the Booking entity and repository contract, BookingModel with its Firestore and mock data sources, BookingRepositoryImpl, the GetBookings, CreateBooking and CancelBooking use cases, BookingBloc and BookingFormCubit, the Booking and My Bookings screens, and the booking widgets (success sheet, booking tile,

S/N	Group Member	Role	Attendance	Commits	Contribution
					review sheet, date sheet). Also built NavCubit and MainShell, and configured the iOS Xcode project.
4	Gift Don-Emmanuel	Property module lead	19–31 July 2026	6	Delivered the property feature end to end across all three layers: domain (Property entity, repository contract, and the GetProperties, SearchProperties and ToggleFavorite use cases), data (PropertyModel, the seed catalogue, Firestore and mock data sources, PropertyRepositoryImpl) and presentation (PropertyBloc, SearchCubit, the Home, Explore, Search, Favorites and Details screens, the property card and share sheet). Also contributed the iOS platform files.
5	David Muotoh	Matching, listings, backend configuration and documentation	19–31 July 2026	51	Built the lifestyle questionnaire feature across all three layers and the CompatibilityScorer that powers the match percentage and the "Why?" breakdown. Built the create-listing flow, the PhotoService and picker, the settings feature with persisted preferences, and listing edit and delete ("My Listings"). Configured the Firebase project, authored firestore.rules and firestore.indexes.json, set up the Android platform, and wrote the README, the ERD and this report.

A note on commit counts. Commit count and contribution volume are not the same measure, and the table reports both rather than smoothing the difference. Gift's six commits, for instance, delivered the whole property module — the largest single feature in the application — because that work was committed in a small number of layer-sized commits, whereas members who committed more incrementally accumulated higher counts for comparable work. Feature

ownership, in the right-hand column, is the more meaningful measure, and every claim in it can be verified against the repository with `git log --author="<name>".`

ABSTRACT

The aim of this project was to develop **Houseslice**, a mobile application built with the Flutter framework and backed by Google Firebase. Flutter is a cross-platform toolkit that allows a single Dart codebase to target Android and iOS (Flutter Documentation, 2024).

The tools and methodologies applied include Flutter, Firebase Authentication, Cloud Firestore, the BLoC (Business Logic Component) pattern for state management, Clean Architecture for code organisation (Martin, 2017), and Agile with Scrum for project management (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020).

Houseslice addresses a specific problem in Kigali's student housing market: students searching for accommodation and housemates rely on unmoderated Facebook groups and WhatsApp chains, where anyone can post, nothing is verified, and there is no reliable way to tell a fellow student from a letting agent. The application responds with a **verified, student-only marketplace** gated behind university email domains. Its distinguishing feature is a **lifestyle compatibility engine**: students answer an eleven-question lifestyle questionnaire, and every shared-home listing then displays a live match percentage together with a breakdown explaining that score across nine dimensions. The application also supports publishing, editing and deleting listings, a booking flow with a range calendar and price breakdown, per-user favourites, and preferences that persist across restarts.

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1. INTRODUCTION

1.1 Objectives

The objective of this project is to develop Houseslice, a mobile application that helps university students in Kigali find accommodation and compatible housemates inside a trusted, verified community.

To achieve this, the project focuses on building a cross-platform mobile application in Flutter, ensuring the interface matches the team's Figma prototype and behaves correctly across device sizes and orientations. Firebase Authentication manages accounts through two independent sign-in methods, and Cloud Firestore stores listings, bookings, favourites and profiles behind security rules that restrict every document to its owner.

Beyond the mechanics of listing and booking, the project sets out to solve a matching problem rather than only a search problem. Existing channels help a student find *a room*; Houseslice aims to help them find *the right room and the right housemate*, by modelling lifestyle compatibility explicitly and explaining it rather than presenting an opaque score.

[INSERT: any additional objectives from the research half of the report.]

1.2 Contributions

[INSERT: the problem statement, literature review, personas, empathy maps, competitor analysis, journey map and storyboard from the research half. This section should establish — with the team's own interview and survey evidence — why student housing in Kigali needs this application. The technical sections below deliberately do not restate research findings, so that nothing in this document is attributed to research that was not actually carried out.]

From a technical standpoint, this project contributes a working reference for several practices the course emphasises:

- A **Clean Architecture** Flutter codebase in which the domain layer imports nothing from Flutter or Firebase, so business rules are independently testable.
- A **compatibility scoring engine** implemented as a pure domain service with no dependency on the UI or the backend, and therefore fully unit-testable.
- **Security rules written alongside the features they protect**, so that what the interface offers and what the backend permits cannot drift apart.
- A **responsive-layout regression suite** that asserts every screen lays out without overflow at three viewport sizes, catching a class of defect that manual testing in portrait consistently

misses.

2. APPLICATION DESIGN

2.1 Application Features

Onboarding. A branded splash screen, three introduction slides and a location chooser. Whether the introduction appears is stored as a preference, so returning students go straight to sign-in.

Authentication. Two independent methods — university email and password, and Google Sign-In. Both are gated to allowed university domains (`alustudent.com`, `alueducation.com`, `ur.ac.rw`, `auca.ac.rw`), so a personal Gmail account cannot get in even through the Google flow. The feature includes email verification, a password-reset flow and a change-password screen. Registration validates every field before any network call is made, and shows a specific message rather than a generic failure (Figure 1).

8:37



 25

Register Account

Sign up with your university email to join a verified student community

Email

name@alustudent.com

Username

Username

Password

Password



☒ Agree with **terms** and **privacy**

Or





Figure 1. Registration screen with university-email validation

Lifestyle questionnaire. Eleven questions plus a free-text introduction, covering bedtime, cleanliness, social life, study habits, guests, smoking, budget, gender and gender preference, sharing style and pets (Figure 2).

8:37 M ⓘ 🔒 •

9/12 Skip

Do you smoke?

We never match a smoker with someone who wants a smoke-free home.

☒ I don't, and prefer non-smokers

☐ I don't, but I don't mind

☐ Occasionally

☐ Yes, I smoke

Next

Figure 2. Lifestyle questionnaire

Compatibility matching. Every shared-home listing displays a live match percentage computed against the student's own answers. Tapping "**Why?**" opens a breakdown across nine dimensions, each with a sentence explaining what the score means (Figure 5). This is the application's distinguishing feature: the score is explained rather than asserted.

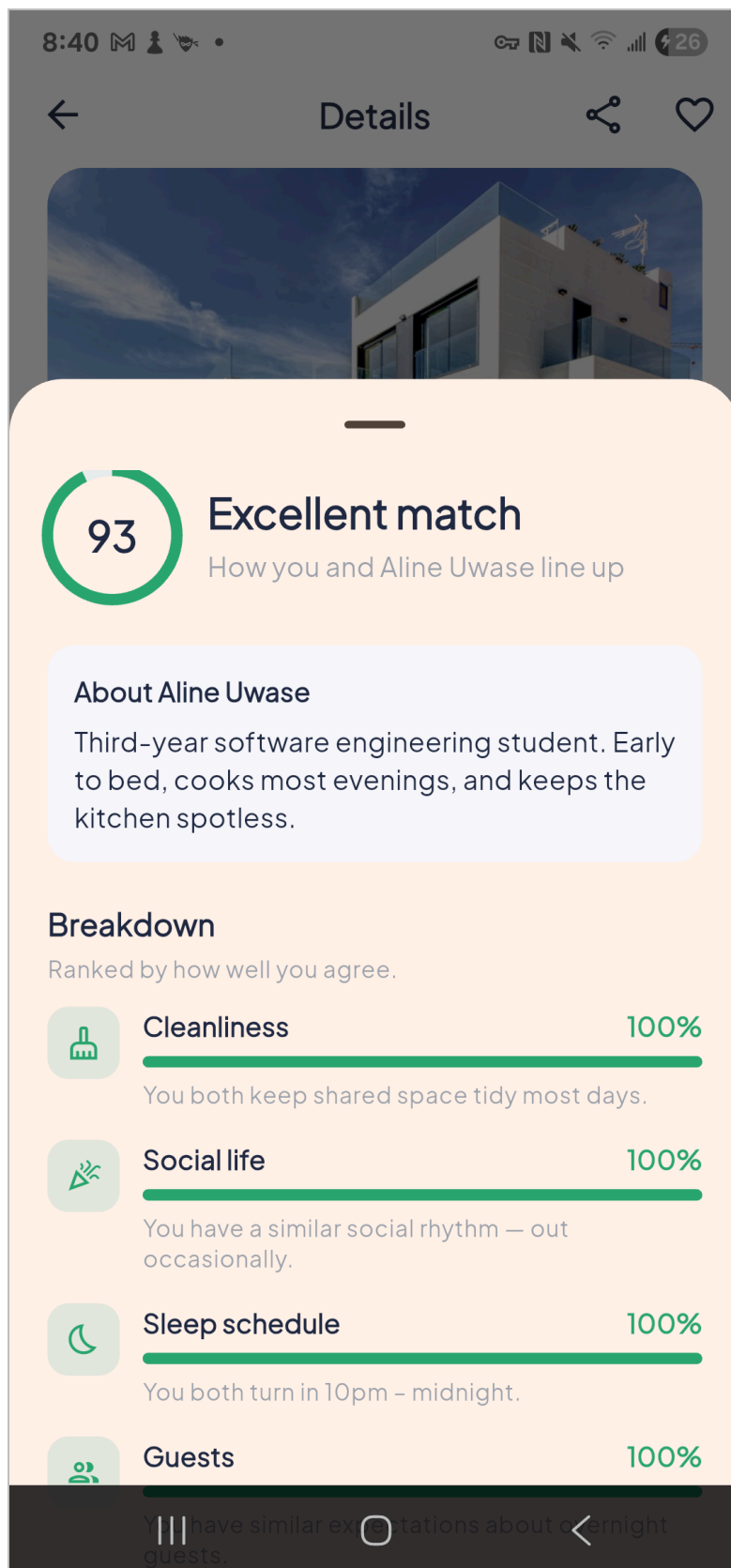


Figure 5. "Why are we compatible?" breakdown sheet

Student and realtor badges. Every listing states at a glance whether it came from a fellow student or a letting agent (Figure 3).

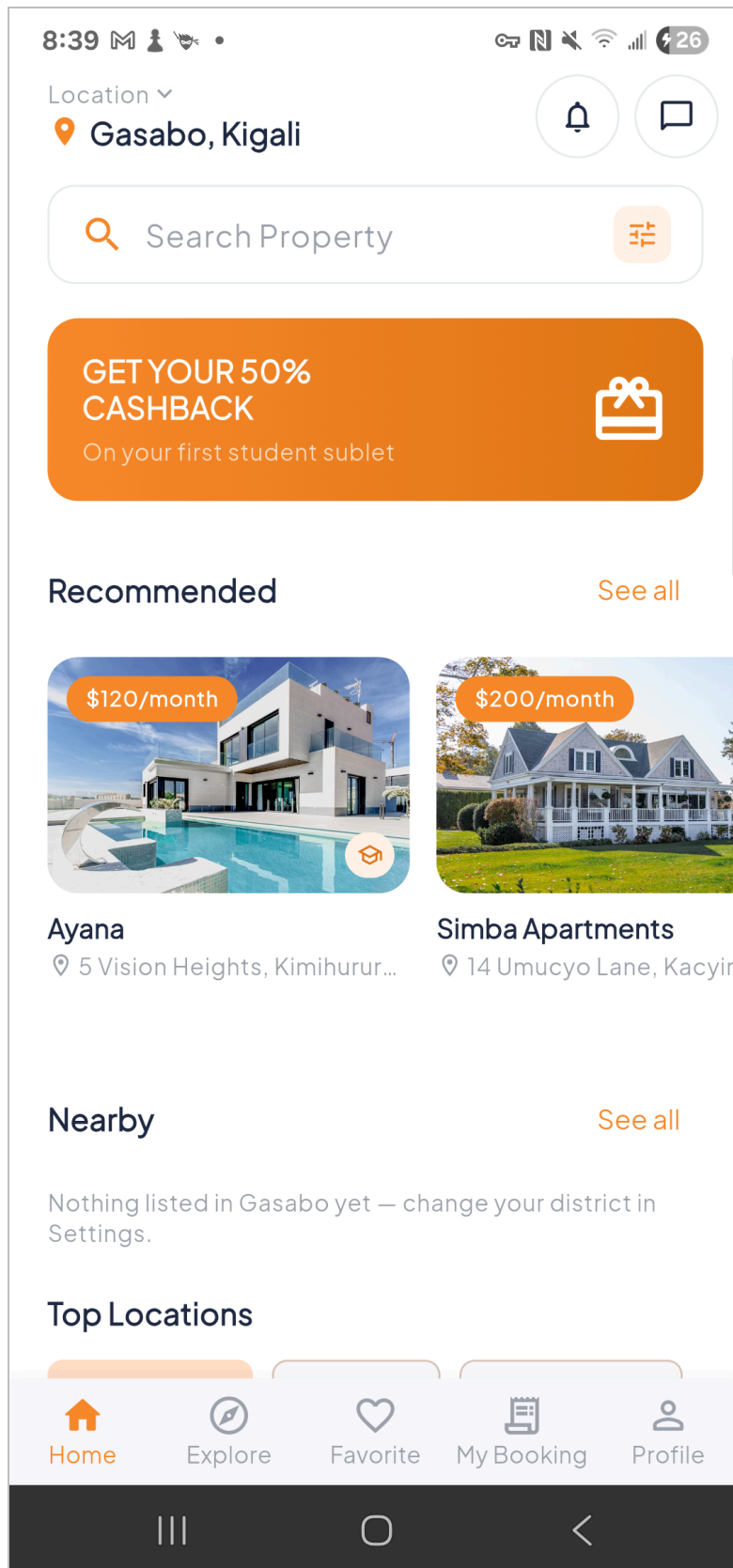


Figure 3. Home feed with compatibility scores and host badges

Publishing, editing and deleting a listing. Students sublet a room; agents post a whole property. Selecting "Realtor" automatically forces "Entire place", because an agency has no lifestyle profile to match against. **My Listings** shows everything the signed-in student has published, with edit and delete actions on each row.

Explore and search. Grid browsing, live search with Recent and Result sections, and a "Search not found" empty state (Figure 6).

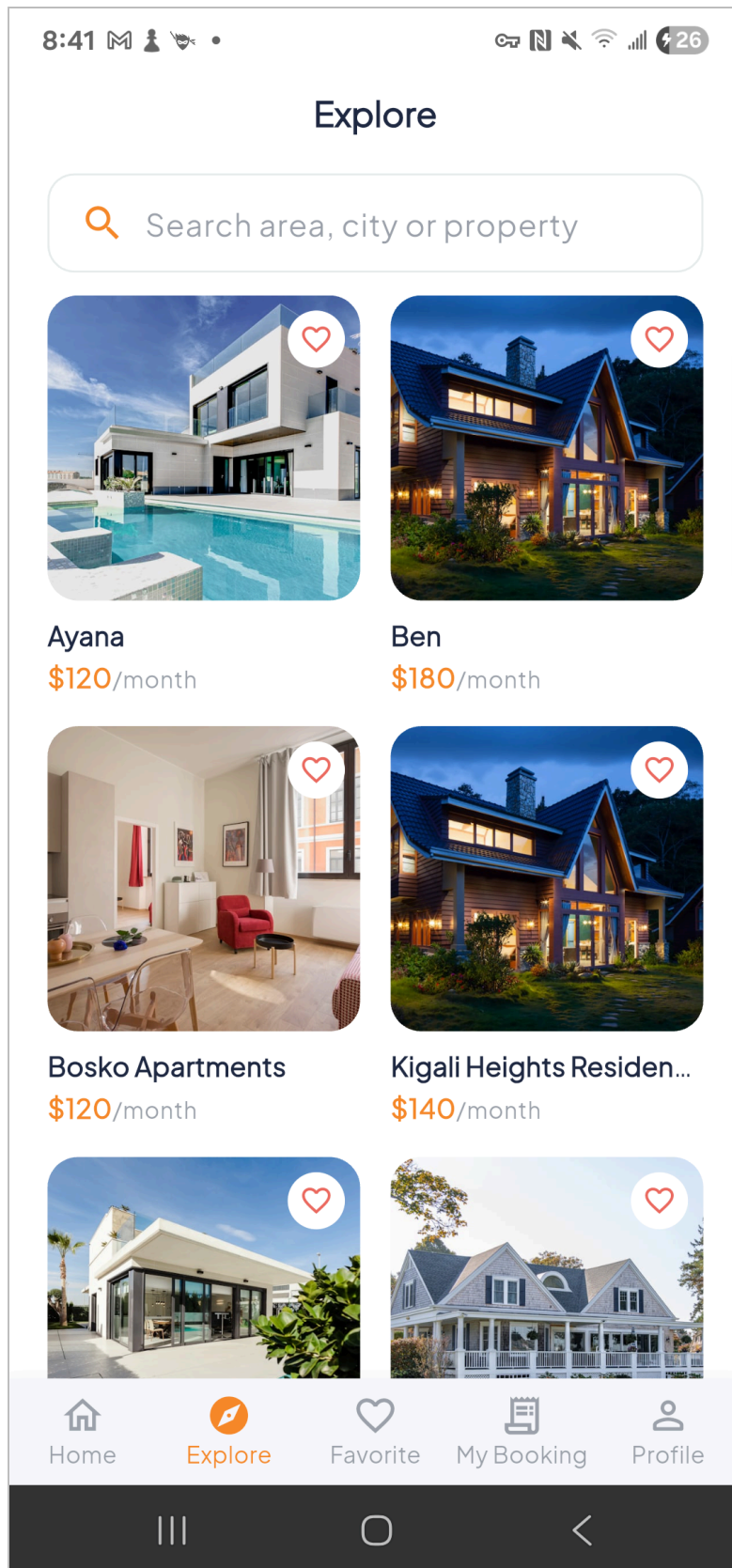


Figure 6. Explore grid

Listing details. A photo gallery with thumbnails, an about section, a verified-host card and a share sheet (Figure 4).

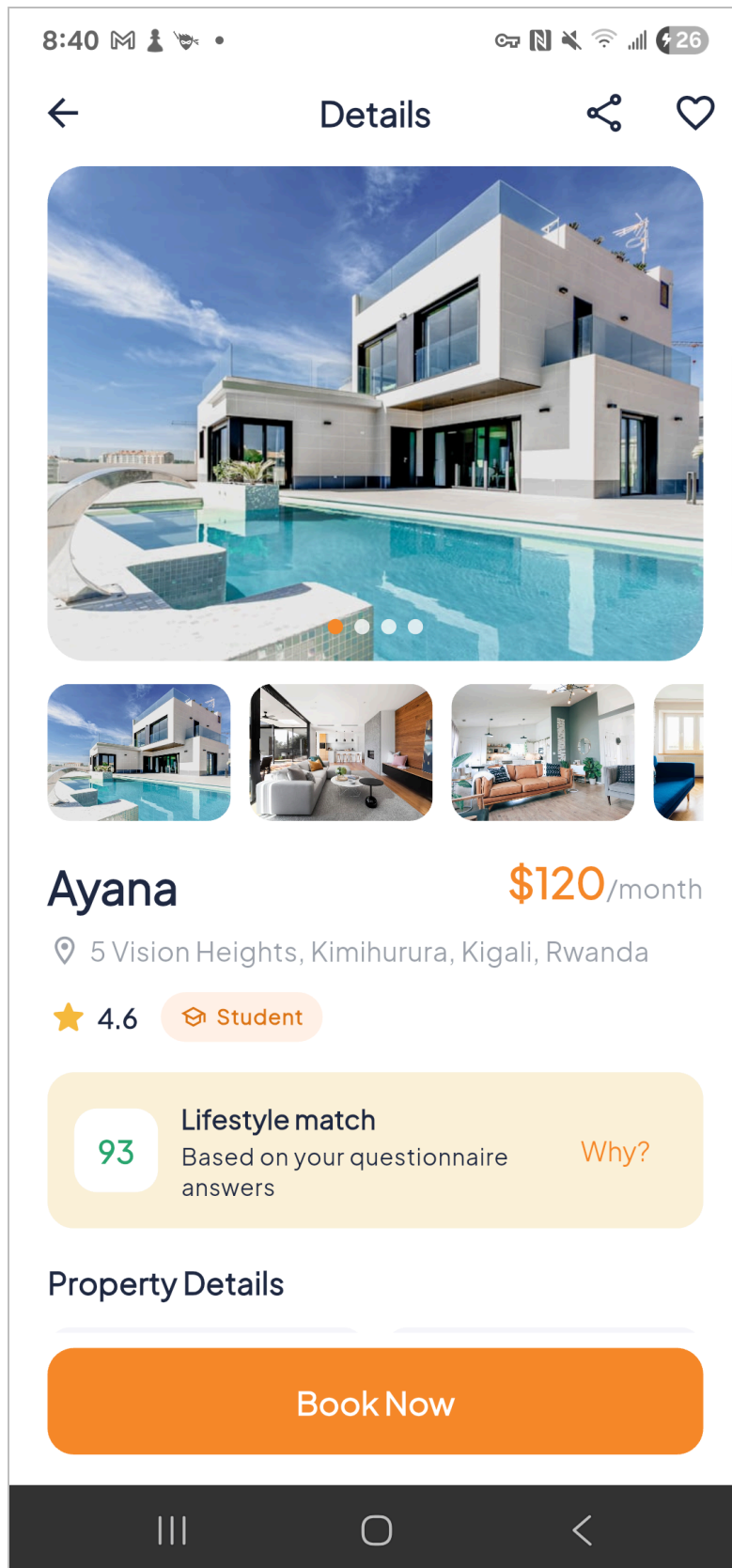


Figure 4. Listing details screen

Favourites. Per-user, synchronised to Firestore, with an optimistic heart toggle so the interface responds instantly (Figure 7).

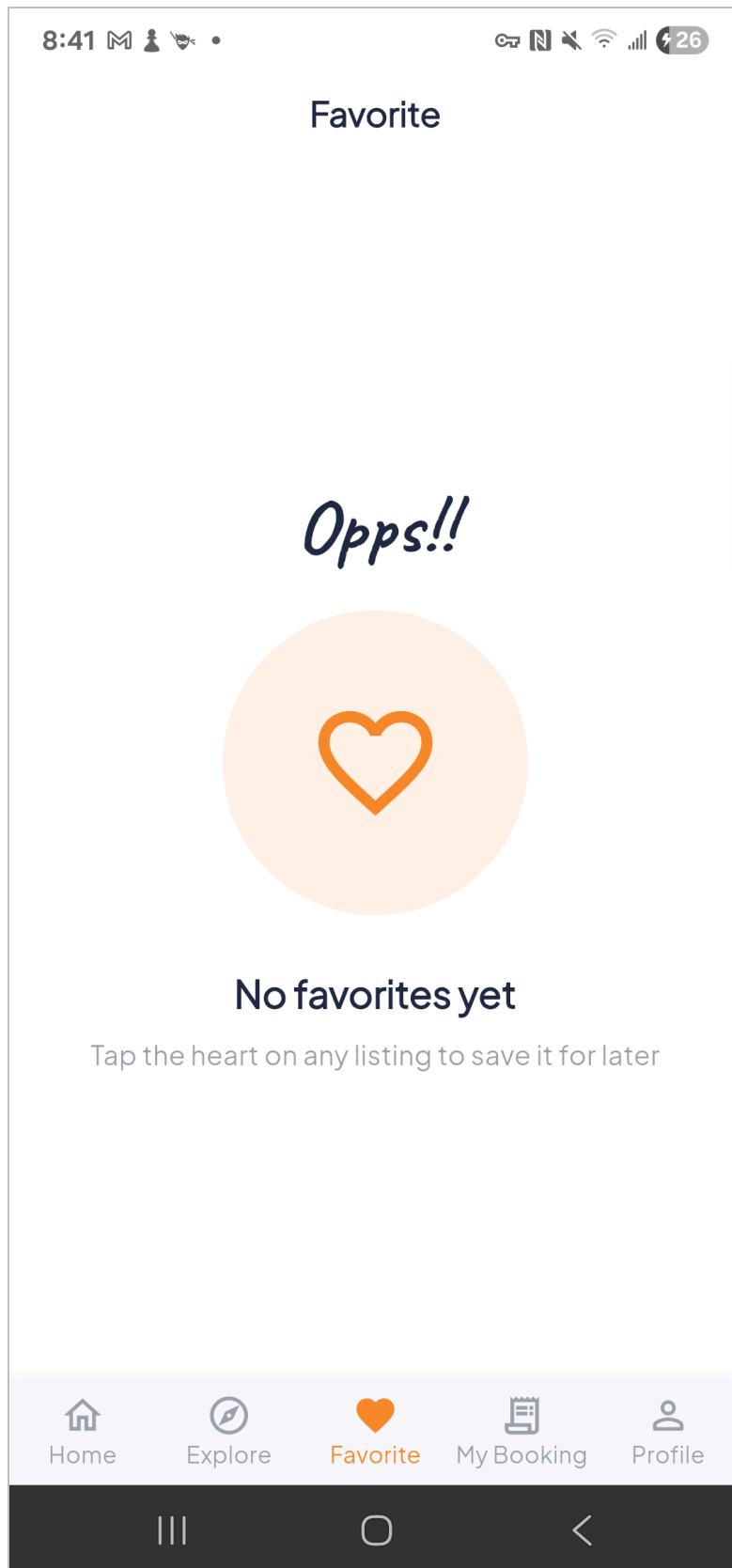


Figure 7. Favourites

Booking. A custom range calendar, payment-method selection (card or mobile money), an Add Card screen with Luhn checksum and expiry validation, a price breakdown with tax, and a success sheet.

My Bookings. Upcoming, Completed and Cancelled tabs with status chips, a write-review sheet, a call-agent action and illustrated empty states (Figure 8).

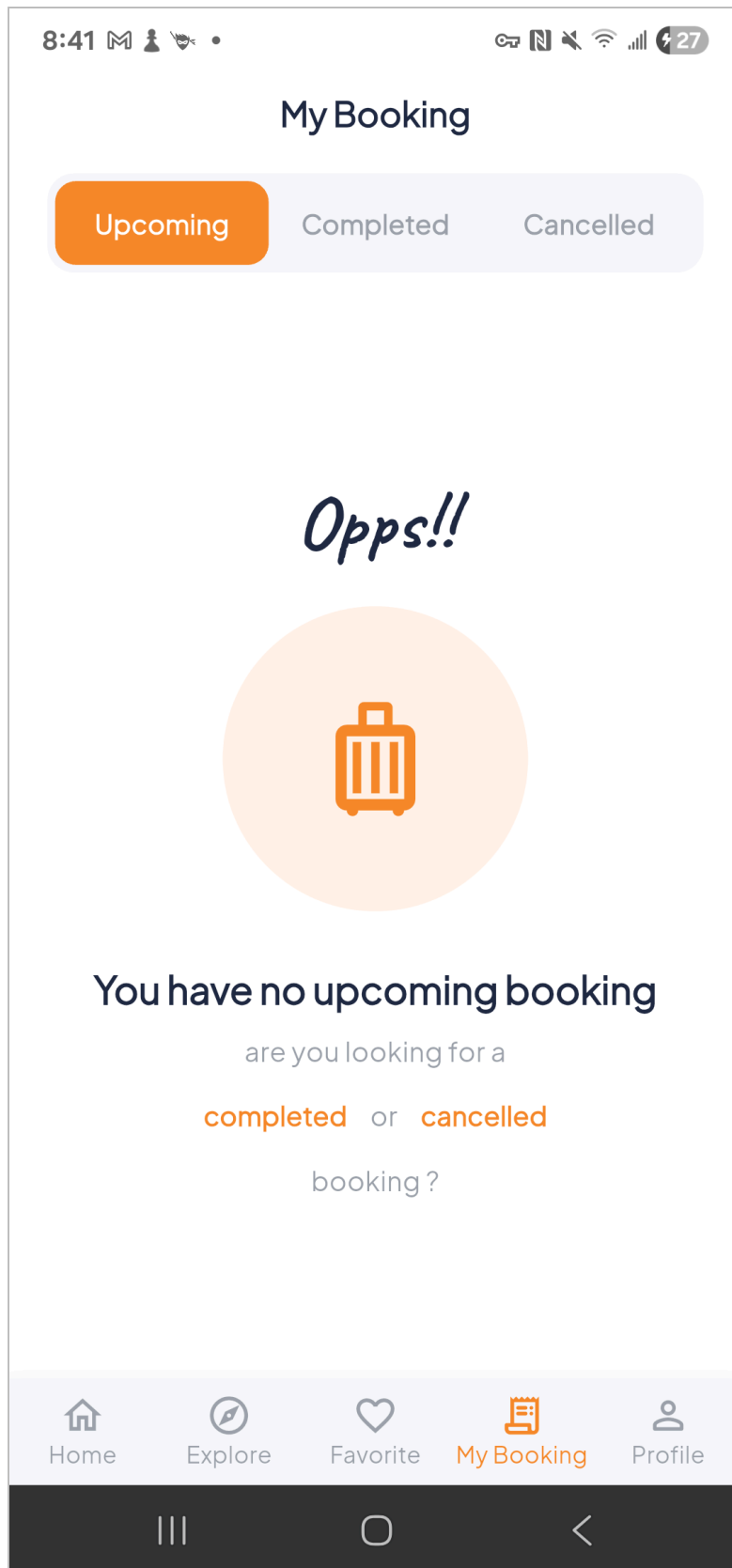


Figure 8. My Bookings across status tabs

Settings. Four preferences persisted across restarts: colour theme (system, light or dark), notification opt-in, preferred Kigali district, and whether onboarding has been seen (Figures 10 and 11).

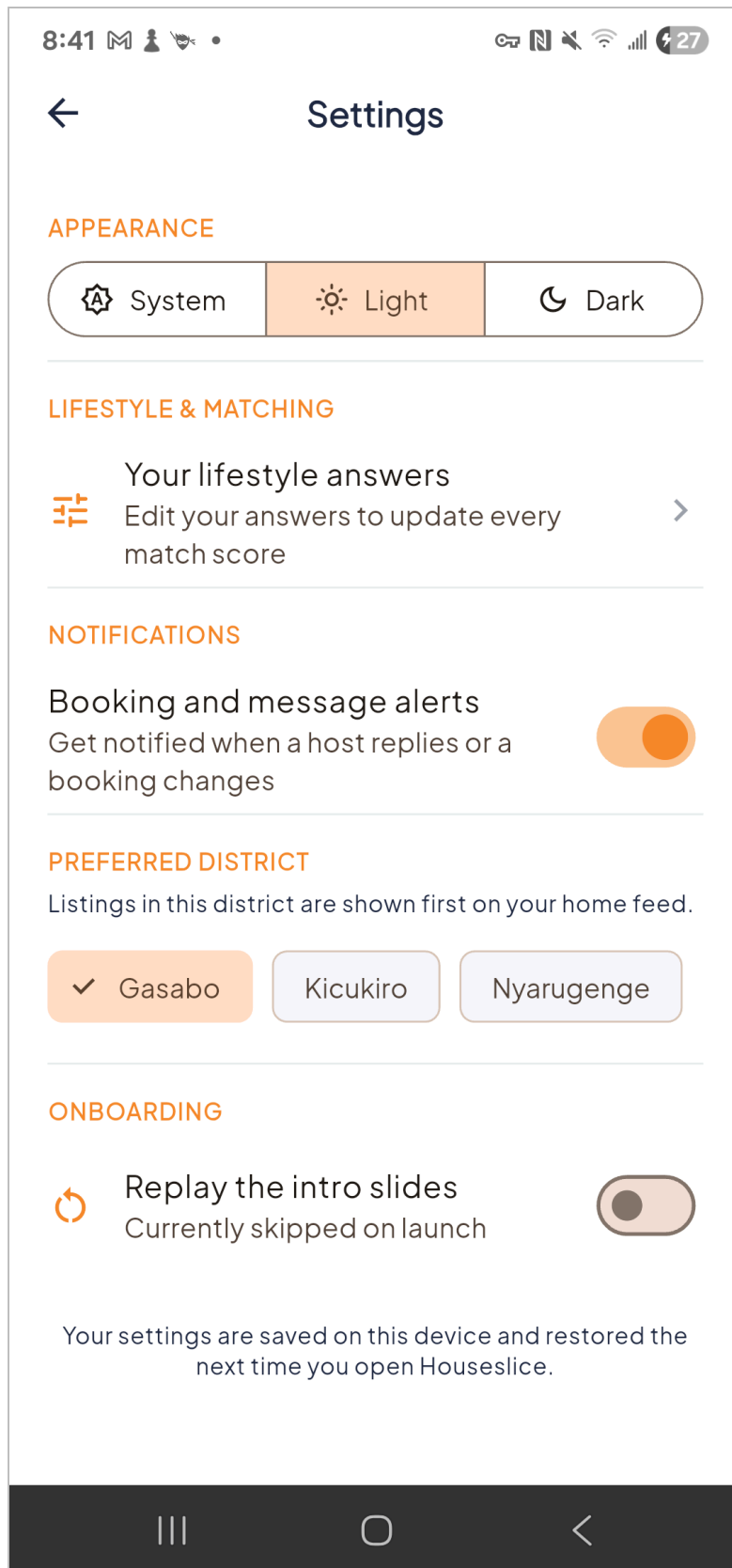


Figure 10. Settings in light theme

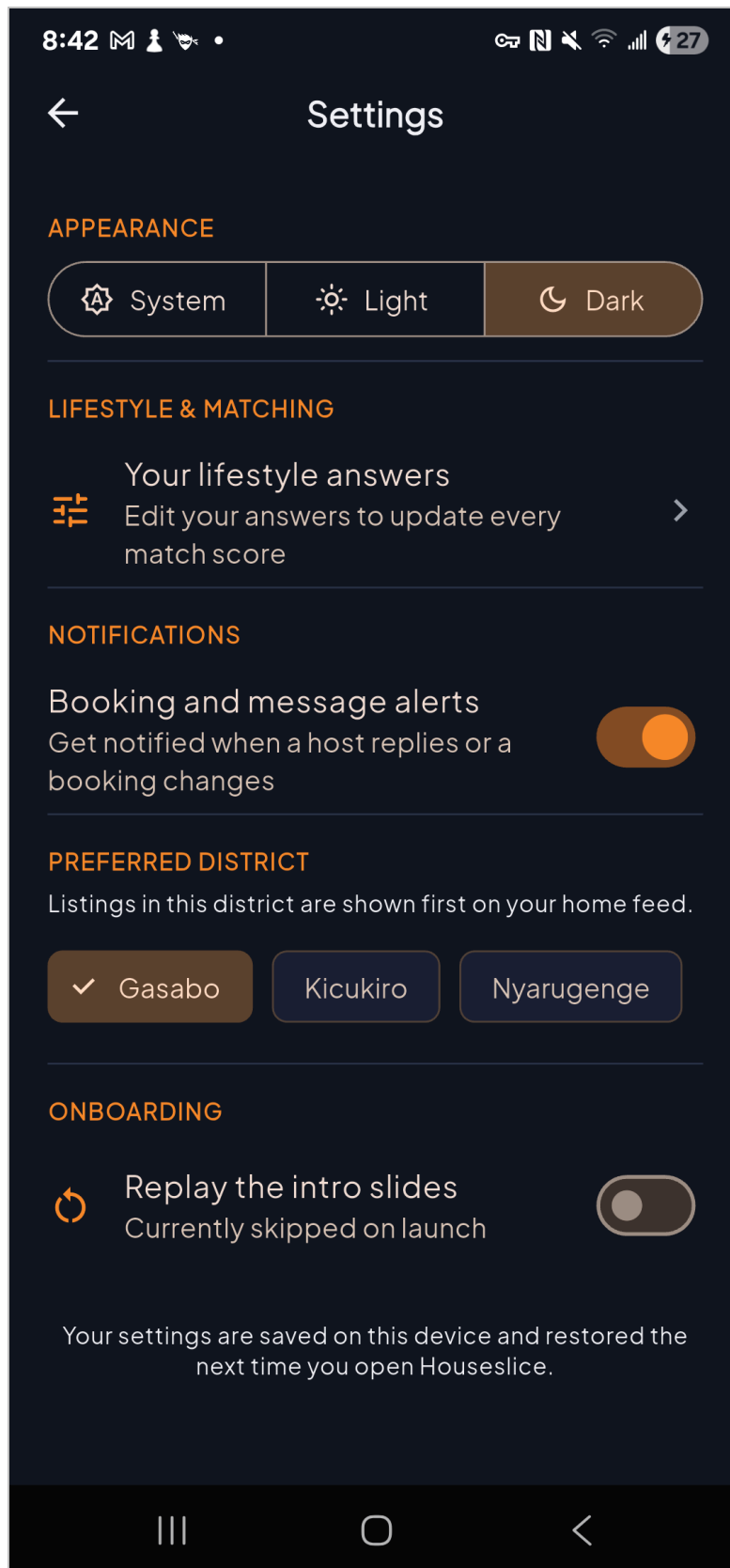


Figure 11. Settings in dark theme

Profile. Edit profile, change password, notifications, about and sign out (Figure 9).

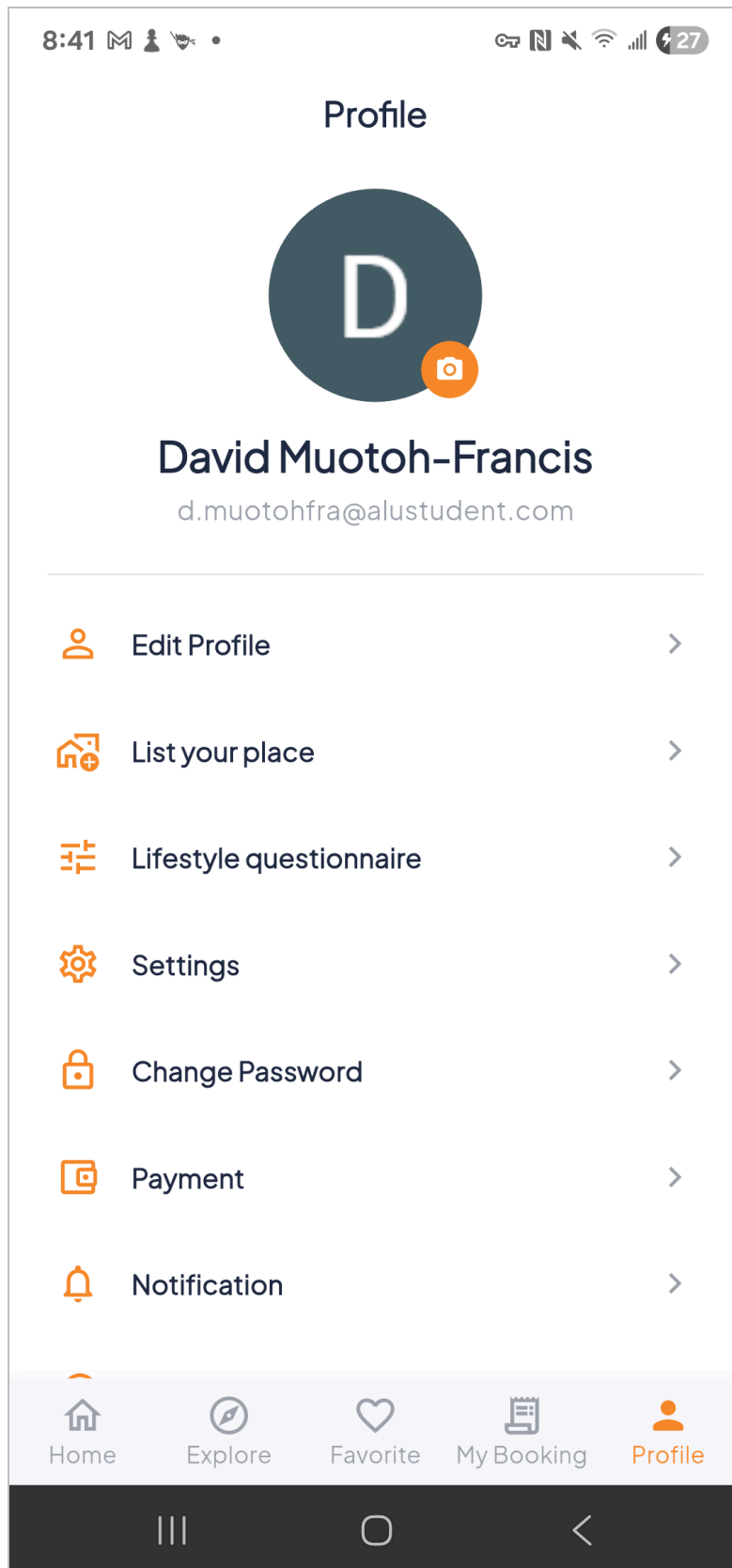


Figure 9. Profile

2.2 Overview of UI

The interface was implemented directly from the team's Figma prototype. A fixed bottom navigation bar switches between Home, Explore, Favourites, Bookings and Profile, and every other screen is reached through named routes handled by a central router, so navigation never leaves the back stack in an inconsistent state.

The application ships light and dark themes, both defined centrally in `AppTheme`. Colour choices were checked against the WCAG 2.1 AA contrast requirement of 4.5:1 for body text (W3C, 2018); the dark palette records its measured ratios in `app_colors.dart` — `darkText` at approximately 15.8:1, `darkGrey` at 7.4:1 and the primary accent at 6.9:1 against the dark background.

Layout responsiveness is verified automatically rather than by eye. Every argument-free screen is pumped at 320×568, 430×932 and 932×430 and asserted to lay out without a `RenderFlex` overflow — see Section 6.

3. RELEVANT TECHNOLOGIES

3.1 Flutter Framework

Flutter is an open-source UI toolkit developed by Google for building applications for Android, iOS, web and desktop from a single codebase. It uses the Dart language and provides a large library of composable widgets (Flutter Documentation, 2024).

Flutter's hot reload was the single biggest contributor to development speed on this project: interface changes appear on the device in under a second, which turned translating the Figma prototype into widgets into an iterative process rather than a compile-and-wait one.

Flutter's widget composition model also made the compatibility feature straightforward to express. The match percentage, its colour band and the explanation sheet are separate stateless widgets driven from a single state object, so the same score is presented consistently on the home feed, the explore grid and the details screen without duplicated logic.

3.2 BLoC Design Pattern and Clean Architecture

The BLoC pattern separates business logic from the user interface. A BLoC receives *events* and emits *states*; the UI dispatches events and rebuilds in response to states, and never performs business logic itself (Angelov, 2024).

A **Cubit** is the simplified form of the same idea: it exposes methods instead of events and emits states directly. Houseslice uses both, choosing between them deliberately:

- **BLoC** where an action has a meaningful, auditable event history — authentication, listings and bookings.
- **Cubit** where the state is a simple value with no event semantics worth recording — form state, questionnaire progress, tab selection, preferences.

This sits on top of **Clean Architecture** (Martin, 2017), which organises each feature into three layers under a strict dependency rule:

```
presentation → domain ← data
```

The **domain** layer sits at the centre and depends on nothing. It holds entities, repository contracts and use cases, and imports neither Flutter nor Firebase. The **data** layer implements the domain's contracts against a concrete backend. The **presentation** layer holds BLoCs, Cubits, pages and widgets.

The practical consequence is testability. `CompatibilityScorer` is a plain Dart class in the domain layer, so its unit tests need no widget tree, no Firebase emulator and no mocking framework. Equally, replacing Firestore with another backend would mean rewriting only the data layer.

`setState` is not used for business logic anywhere in the codebase. The few remaining occurrences manage ephemeral UI state that no other widget observes — a photo-picker spinner, a "read more" expansion toggle, a text-controller listener — which is what `setState` is actually for.

Use cases return a `Result<T>` — either `Success(value)` or `Err(Failure)` — rather than throwing. Exceptions are caught at the data-layer boundary and converted, so a BLoC never sees a `FirebaseException` and the presentation layer never sees a data-layer type.

3.3 Google Firebase

Firebase provides the backend, through two services.

Firebase Authentication manages accounts for both sign-in methods. It handles credential storage, session persistence across application restarts, email verification links and password-reset emails, none of which the team had to implement (Firebase Documentation, 2024).

Cloud Firestore is the NoSQL document database holding listings, profiles, favourites and bookings. Its document and collection model suited the data naturally: per-user data is nested *under* the user document rather than kept in top-level collections with a `userId` field, which makes ownership a property of the document path and therefore straightforward to secure (Section 5.4).

Firestore security rules are declarative and evaluated server-side, so they cannot be bypassed by a modified client (Firebase Security Rules Documentation, 2024).

3.4 Supporting Packages

Package	Purpose
flutter_bloc	BLoC and Cubit state management
equatable	Value equality for states and entities
get_it	Dependency injection and service location
firebase_core, firebase_auth, cloud_firestore	Backend services
google_sign_in	Second authentication method
image_picker	Selecting listing photos from the device gallery
shared_preferences	Persisted user preferences
google_fonts, intl	Typography and date/currency formatting
bloc_test, mocktail	State-machine assertions and test doubles

4. METHODOLOGY

4.1 Project Methodology

The team used **Agile with Scrum** (Schwaber & Sutherland, 2020). Work was organised into short iterations, each ending with a working application rather than an isolated component.

This mattered on a project with five contributors and interdependent modules. Because the interfaces between layers were agreed first — repository contracts and entity shapes — members could build the property, booking, authentication and lifestyle modules in parallel without blocking one another. A module could be developed against its contract before the layer beneath it existed.

Feature ownership was assigned per module, which is visible directly in the Git history: each member's commits cluster around their module, and each module was developed on its own branch before being merged into main.

4.2 Development Process and Tools

Version control. GitHub, with a branch per feature — feature/property-module, feature/booking-domain, features/auth, feature/app-shell, feature/ios-platform, feature/android-platform, feature/test-suites and feature/listing-management — merged into main.

Development environment. Visual Studio Code and Android Studio with the Flutter and Dart extensions. `flutter doctor -v` was used to verify that each member's environment matched.

Quality gates. Three commands were run before any merge:

```
dart format lib test      # consistent formatting
flutter analyze lib test  # zero static analysis issues
flutter test              # the full suite must pass
```

Design. Figma for the prototype, which the implementation follows screen by screen.

4.3 Disclosure of AI Assistance

In line with the assessment's academic-integrity requirements, the team discloses the following use of AI tools.

What AI was used for. An AI coding assistant was used as a reviewing and debugging aid during development, in three specific ways.

1. **Code review before merge.** The assistant reviewed diffs and identified defects that the team then verified and fixed. Five are worth naming because they were real: two RenderFlex overflow errors visible only in landscape orientation (134 px on the location chooser, 34 px on the create-password form); a demo-mode data source that stamped a hardcoded owner identifier, so a newly registered account's listing never appeared under My Listings; an error-handling flaw in which a failed favourites cleanup reported an already-successful delete as failed; and an edit path that could overwrite a listing's stored lifestyle data with an empty profile.
2. **Test scaffolding.** The assistant helped write the responsive-layout suite and parts of the listing-management tests. Every test was reviewed and run by the team, and the suite passes in full.
3. **Documentation drafting.** Portions of this report and the README were drafted with AI assistance and then edited by the team for accuracy.

What AI was not used for. The application's architecture, the compatibility scoring model, the database design, the Firebase security rules and the Figma prototype are the team's own work. The research half of this report — problem statement, literature review, personas, competitor analysis and journey mapping — was produced by the team without AI generation.

Estimated proportion. AI-assisted content is estimated at **under 40%** of the submitted work, concentrated in review, test scaffolding and documentation drafting rather than in design decisions or original analysis. All AI-suggested code was read, understood and verified before being committed, and the team is able to explain every line of the codebase on request.

5. IMPLEMENTATION

5.1 Project Structure

Code is organised by feature, and each feature by layer. No source file sits loose in lib/.

```
lib/
├─ main.dart           # Firebase bootstrap, preference preload
├─ app.dart            # MaterialApp + global bloc providers
├─ injection_container.dart # get_it dependency graph
├─ firebase_options.dart # generated by flutterfire configure
├─ core/              # theme, errors, Result, use case base,
                      # validators, formatters, shared widgets, router
├─ features/
│   ├─ auth/          # email/password + Google, reset, verification
│   │   ├─ domain/    # entities, repository contracts, use cases
│   │   ├─ data/      # models, data sources, repository impl
│   │   └─ presentation/ # bloc, cubit, pages, widgets
│   ├─ lifestyle/     # questionnaire, compatibility scoring
│   ├─ onboarding/    # splash, intro slides, location picker
│   ├─ property/      # listings, search, favourites, create/edit
│   ├─ booking/       # checkout, calendar, payment, my bookings
│   ├─ settings/      # persisted preferences
│   ├─ notifications/
│   ├─ profile/
│   └─ shell/         # bottom-navigation main shell
```

Every feature repeats the same domain / data / presentation split, so a developer who learns one feature's layout knows them all.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT (Figure 18): the lib/ folder expanded in the editor.]

5.2 State Management in Practice

Concern	Solution
Auth session, sign in/up/out, Google, profile, verification	AuthBloc
Password reset flow	PasswordResetCubit
Listings, favourites, delete	PropertyBloc
Publishing and editing a listing	CreateListingCubit
Search results and recents	SearchCubit
Bookings (load, create, cancel)	BookingBloc
Checkout form (dates, payment method)	BookingFormCubit
Lifestyle answers (application-wide)	LifestyleCubit
Questionnaire progress	QuizCubit
User preferences	PreferencesCubit
Small UI state (tabs, toggles, gallery index)	ToggleCubit / IndexCubit

Three decisions in this table are worth defending, because they are the kind of thing a reviewer may ask about during the demonstration.

LifestyleCubit and PreferencesCubit are registered as singletons, not factories. Every listing card scores against the student's questionnaire answers, and every screen renders in the chosen theme. Were these factories, different parts of the widget tree would hold different instances and could disagree — one screen showing a stale match percentage, or the settings screen disagreeing with `MaterialApp` about the current theme.

Rebuilds are scoped deliberately. `MaterialApp` is wrapped in a `BlocBuilder` whose `buildWhen` fires only when the *theme* preference changes, so toggling an unrelated setting does not tear down and rebuild the entire widget tree.

Updates are optimistic. Favouriting and deleting both update the interface before the network round trip completes, then revert and show an explanatory message if the write is rejected. This is why the heart responds instantly rather than after a visible pause.

5.3 Database Design

The full entity–relationship diagram with field-level tables is in docs/ERD.md. Every field name below matches the code exactly.

Figure 12 — Entity–relationship diagram

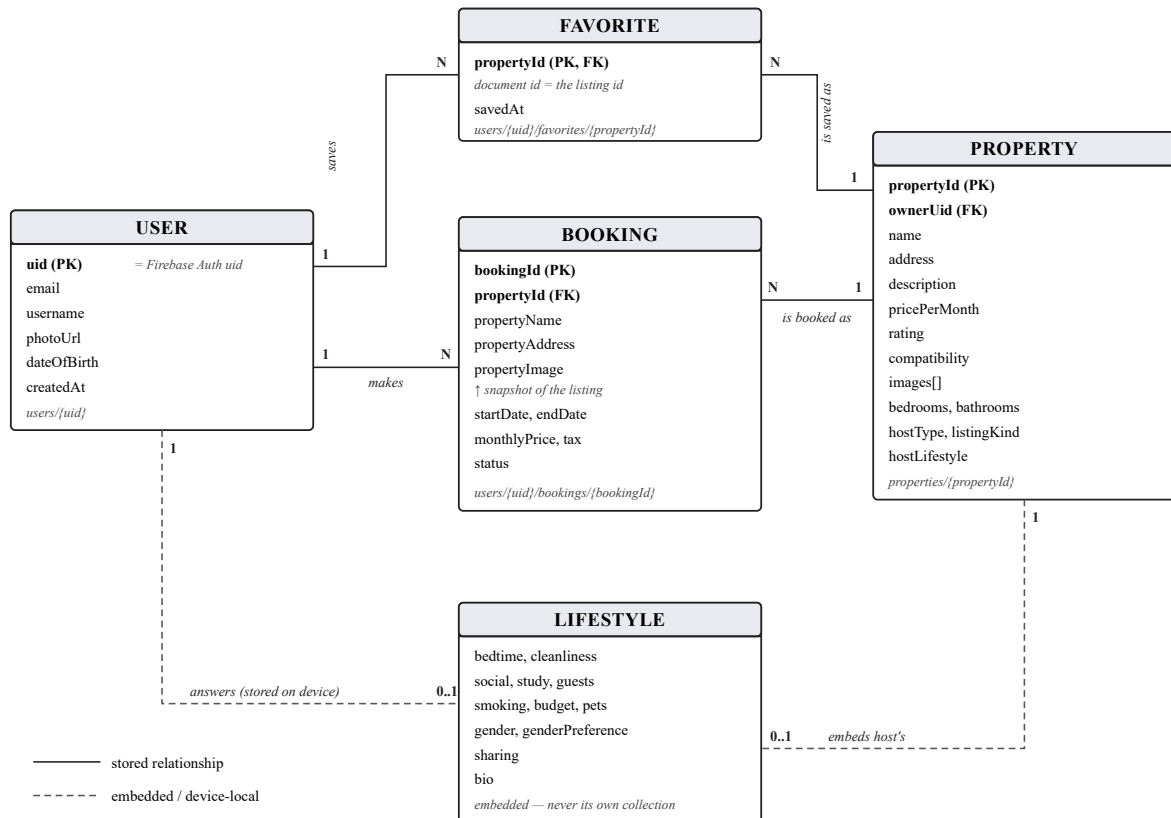


Figure 12. Entity–relationship diagram. Solid lines are stored relationships; dashed lines are embedded or device-local data.

Collection layout.

Path	Document id	Owner
properties/{propertyId}	slug or auto-id	the publisher (ownerUid)
users/{uid}	Firebase Auth uid	that user
users/{uid}/favorites/{propertyId}	the listing id	that user
users/{uid}/bookings/{bookingId}	Firestore auto-id	that user

Three design decisions.

Per-user data is nested under `users/{uid}` rather than kept in top-level collections with a `userId` field. Ownership therefore becomes a property of the document path, so a single rule (`request.auth.uid == uid`) secures every subcollection, and cross-user queries are impossible by construction rather than by convention.

A favourite's document id is the listing id, which makes the relationship the key itself. Writing a favourite twice is idempotent, and the document body needs no `propertyId` field at all — only `savedAt`.

Bookings deliberately duplicate listing data. `propertyName`, `propertyAddress`, `propertyImage` and `monthlyPrice` are stored on the booking alongside `propertyId`. This is a **snapshot**, not accidental denormalisation: a booking is a financial record, and if a host later edits their listing's price, past bookings must still show what was actually agreed. It also avoids an extra read per row when rendering My Bookings. Everything else in the schema is stored exactly once.

Indexes. `firestore.indexes.json` declares composite indexes for filtering bookings by `status` while ordering by `startDate` — the query behind the Upcoming, Completed and Cancelled tabs. Single-field indexes are omitted because Firestore maintains them automatically and rejects explicit declarations at deploy time.

5.4 Firebase Security Rules

The rules live in `firestore.rules` and are deployed to the live project.

Path	Read	Write
<code>properties/{id}</code>	any signed-in user	create only as yourself (<code>ownerUid == auth.uid</code>); edit and delete only your own; <code>ownerUid</code> immutable; field validation applied to both create and update
<code>users/{uid}</code>	owner only	owner only; <code>email</code> immutable after creation; <code>username</code> at least 3 characters
<code>users/{uid}/favorites/{id}</code>	owner only	owner only; body must be exactly <code>{savedAt}</code>
<code>users/{uid}/bookings/{id}</code>	owner only	owner only; on update only status may change
anything else	denied	denied

Five properties are worth stating explicitly, because each defends against a specific attack rather than being generic boilerplate.

1. Nothing is readable while signed out. There is no public path. A catch-all match `/{{document=**}} { allow read, write: if false; }` closes anything not explicitly matched above it.

2. A listing cannot be hijacked or handed over. Creation requires `incoming().ownerUid == request.auth.uid`, so a student cannot publish in someone else's name. Update additionally requires `incoming().ownerUid == resource.data.ownerUid`, making ownership immutable: a listing cannot be transferred, and someone else's cannot be claimed.

3. Create and update share the same validation. A `validListing()` helper checks that `name` is a non-empty string, `pricePerMonth` is a positive number, and `hostType` and `listingKind` hold permitted values. Both create and update call it, so an edit cannot write a document that would have been rejected as a new listing — a gap that existed until it was found in review.

4. Booking money is immutable. The update rule uses `request.resource.data.diff(resource.data).affectedKeys().hasOnly(['status'])`, so a client can move a booking through its status lifecycle but cannot rewrite `monthlyPrice`, `tax` or the dates of a stay that has already been agreed.

5. Verification status cannot be forged. `emailVerified` is deliberately *never* persisted to Firestore. It is read from the Firebase Auth token on every load, so writing to one's own profile document cannot manufacture a verified badge.

Critically, **the interface offers exactly what the rules permit**. My Listings decides which rows to show using `ownerUid` — the same field the rules check — so a student is never shown an Edit button for a listing the backend would refuse to let them edit.

5.5 CRUD Operations

All four operations are exercised against Cloud Firestore from the front end.

Operation	Where it happens
Create	Publish a listing; create a booking; favourite a listing; create a profile on registration
Read	Load the catalogue; search; load bookings; load favourites; load profile
Update	Edit a published listing; cancel a booking (status transition); edit profile; change password
Delete	Delete a published listing; unfavourite a listing

Every operation updates the interface immediately and reports failure through a `SnackBar` rather than failing silently. Favouriting and deletion are optimistic: the change appears at once and is reverted, with an explanatory message, if the backend rejects it.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT (Figure 14): the Firestore console showing a document created or modified by the application, ideally beside the phone.]

5.6 Authentication

Two independent methods are implemented, and both work against the live Firebase project.

Email and password. Registration validates the email format, restricts the domain to a supported university, and requires a username of at least three characters and a password of at least six. On success a verification email is sent immediately and a profile document is created at `users/{uid}`.

Google Sign-In. The Google account's email is checked against the same university domain list *before* a Firebase session is created, and the Google session is dropped if the check fails — so a personal Gmail account cannot enter through the social route. On first sign-in a profile document is created; on subsequent sign-ins the existing profile is left intact.

Security features implemented:

- **Email verification** sent on registration and re-sendable from the profile.
- **Input validation** on every field, so blank or malformed input is rejected before any network call is made.
- **Domain gating** on *both* methods.
- **Password reset** by email, which deliberately does not reveal whether an address is registered: a user-not-found error returns silently rather than confirming that the account does not exist.
- **Session persistence.** The session survives an application restart, and signing out clears the Google session as well as the Firebase one, so the next sign-in shows the account picker instead of silently reusing the last account.

Error messages are specific rather than generic. Firebase error codes are mapped to sentences a student can act on — "Incorrect email or password", "An account already exists with this email. Sign in instead", "No internet connection. Check your network", "Too many attempts. Try again in a moment" — rather than surfacing a raw exception.

5.7 User Preferences

Five values persist on the device through `shared_preferences` and are restored *before the first frame is drawn*, so the application opens directly in the student's chosen theme rather than

flashing the default one:

1. **Colour theme** — system, light or dark.
 2. **Notification opt-in.**
 3. **Preferred Kigali district**, used to pre-filter listings.
 4. **Onboarding seen**, so returning students skip the intro slides.
 5. **Lifestyle questionnaire answers**, which are needed on every listing card and would otherwise cost a network round trip per card.
-

6. TESTING

```
flutter analyze lib test    # 0 issues
flutter test                # 298 tests, all passing
flutter test --coverage     # 74.5% line coverage (3,712 / 4,984 lines)
```

The suite covers validators, formatters, entities, models, data sources, repositories, BLoCs and Cubits, and every screen — including the modal sheets.

Widget tests run against the real dependency graph in demo mode rather than against mocked BLoCs. A single screen test therefore exercises presentation, domain and data together, which is what makes them worth writing: a test that renders My Listings and taps Delete really does travel through PropertyBloc, the DeleteListing use case, the repository and the data source.

Unit tests cover the domain in isolation — the compatibility scorer, validators, formatters, entity behaviour, model serialisation round-trips, and BLoC state transitions asserted with `bloc_test`.

Responsive-layout tests (`test/features/responsive_layout_test.dart`) pump every argument-free screen at three viewports — 320×568 (the smallest supported phone), 430×932 (the design reference) and 932×430 (landscape rotation) — and fail on any `RenderFlex` overflow.

That approach paid for itself. The widget tests exposed **ten real layout overflow defects** that had shipped unnoticed: in the explore search bar, listing cards, property facilities, booking tiles, the registration consent line, the booking price row, the select-date sheet, the My Bookings segments, and finally the location chooser (134 px in landscape) and the create-new-password form (34 px). All are fixed, and the responsive suite is what keeps them fixed.

[INSERT SCREENSHOT (Figure 15): flutter analyze output showing 0 issues.] *[INSERT SCREENSHOT (Figure 16): flutter test output showing all tests passing.]* *[INSERT SCREENSHOT (Figure 17): the coverage percentage.]*

7. SETUP INSTRUCTIONS

Prerequisites

Tool	Version used
Flutter SDK	3.44.1 (stable)
Dart SDK	^3.12.1
Android SDK	36.1.0
Minimum Android	API 23 (required by <code>firebase_auth</code>)

Running the application

```
git clone https://github.com/davidmuo/houslice.git
cd houslice
flutter pub get
flutter run                # debug
flutter build apk --release # release APK, used for the demonstration
```

`lib/firebase_options.dart` is already generated for the project `houseslice-69a7f`, so the application connects to the live backend on first run. Firebase client keys are public identifiers rather than secrets — access is controlled by the security rules in Section 5.4, not by hiding the key.

Pointing at a different Firebase project

```
dart pub global activate flutterfire_cli
flutterfire configure --project=<your-project-id> --platforms=android,ios
firebase deploy --only firestore:rules,firestore:indexes
```

Then enable **Authentication** → **Email/Password** and **Google** in the Firebase console, and register the debug SHA-1 against the Android app, or Google Sign-In fails with `ApiException: 10`:

```
keytool -list -v -keystore ~/.android/debug.keystore \
  -alias androiddebugkey -storepass android
```

Demo mode

If `firebase_options.dart` is still a placeholder, `main.dart` catches the initialisation failure and the dependency container registers in-memory data sources instead. The application remains fully navigable with no backend, which is what allows the widget test suite to exercise the real dependency graph. Demo account: `j.simmons@alustudent.com / password123`.

8. KNOWN LIMITATIONS AND FUTURE WORK

Being explicit about what is unfinished is more useful than implying the product is complete.

Listing photos are embedded in Firestore rather than held in Cloud Storage. Choosing photos from the device gallery *is* implemented — PhotoService opens the picker, caps images at 900 px and re-encodes at quality 60. Where they land is the compromise: Cloud Storage requires the Blaze billing plan, which this project is not on, so InlinePhotoService stores each photo as a compressed data URI on the listing document, refusing anything over 180 KB to stay clear of Firestore's approximately 1 MiB document ceiling. A production build would swap in FirebasePhotoService — already written and interface-compatible — and store only the download URL.

Payments are not processed. The Add Card screen validates input with a Luhn checksum and renders a preview, but nothing is charged and no card data leaves the device. A real implementation would integrate a PCI-compliant processor and MTN MoMo's API, the natural next step for the Kigali market.

The location step is a searchable district list, not a map. Rendering map tiles requires the Google Maps SDK and a billable API key.

The catalogue must be seeded by an administrator. Because the properties rules only accept listings owned by the caller, the demonstration catalogue cannot self-seed from the client. Listings created inside the application work normally, but a starter catalogue must be imported by an administrator.

In-app messaging is not built. Secure messaging between verified students is the highest-value next feature, since students currently exchange phone numbers in public groups.

Facebook sign-in is decorative. Two authentication methods are implemented and working; the Facebook button states plainly that it is unavailable rather than pretending otherwise.

Compatibility is one-directional. A student sees how well a listing's host matches *them*, but the host is not notified and cannot browse compatible applicants. Making matching mutual is a design problem as much as an engineering one.

Roadmap

1. In-app messaging between verified students
2. Real payment capture (card and MTN MoMo)
3. Photo upload through Cloud Storage

4. Mutual, two-directional compatibility
 5. Map view with real tiles
 6. Expansion beyond Kigali to other African university cities
-

9. CONCLUSION

The development of Houseslice demonstrated how Flutter, Firebase and a disciplined architecture combine to produce a working solution to a real problem in the Kigali student housing market.

The technical goals were met. The application implements two independent authentication methods with domain gating and email verification; full CRUD against Cloud Firestore behind security rules that scope every document to its owner; advanced state management through BLoC and Cubit with no business logic in the UI layer; Clean Architecture with a domain layer that depends on nothing; five preferences persisted across restarts; and a test suite of 298 tests covering unit, widget and responsive-layout concerns at 74.5% line coverage.

Two lessons stand out. The first is that **testing found defects that inspection did not** — ten layout overflow errors, every one of them invisible in portrait orientation on the device the developer happened to be using, plus several logic defects found in code review. Automating the check turned a class of bug from "discovered by a marker" into "caught before merge".

The second is that **security rules and interface design have to be written together**. The most valuable structural decision in the project was having My Listings filter on `ownerUid`, the same field the security rules check, so that the actions offered and the writes permitted cannot drift apart. Rules written after the fact tend to be either too permissive to be useful or too strict to work.

Houseslice is a functional, deployable prototype rather than a finished product. With messaging, real payment capture and mutual matching, it could plausibly serve the student community it was designed for.

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[INSERT: the references cited in the research half of the report — literature review, competitor analysis, and any interview or survey methodology sources. Merge them into this list in alphabetical order.]

APPENDIX A — OUTSTANDING INSERTIONS

Every item below must be supplied before submission.

#	Item	Where
1	Facilitator name	Title page
2	ALU logo image	Title page
3	Demo video link (YouTube)	Group Activities
4	Group contribution tracker link	Group Activities
5	Research half: problem statement, literature review, personas, empathy maps, competitor analysis, journey map, storyboard	§1.2
6	Research references, merged alphabetically	§10
7	Screenshot: My Listings with edit and delete	Figure 13
8	Screenshot: Firestore console showing a document written by the app	Figure 14
9	Screenshot: <code>flutter analyze</code> — 0 issues	Figure 15
10	Screenshot: <code>flutter test</code> — all passing	Figure 16
11	Screenshot: coverage percentage	Figure 17
12	Screenshot: <code>lib/</code> folder structure in the editor	Figure 18
13	Existing screenshots 01–11 embedded as Figures 1–11	Throughout